

Standards and Methodologies

CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

Domain: 1.0: Engagement Management

Objective: 1.3: Compare and contrast testing frameworks and methodologies.

Video Overview

This video introduces essential standards and methodologies in penetration testing. You will learn how structured approaches ensure comprehensive and effective security assessments, moving beyond random testing to purposeful and precise engagements. Understanding these frameworks is vital for your certification exam and for applying these concepts in real-world scenarios as a penetration tester. This knowledge will enable you to identify security weaknesses systematically and to align your testing efforts with organizational and regulatory needs.

Key Topics Covered

- The importance of structured approaches in penetration testing
- **MITRE ATT&CK Framework:** A global knowledge base of adversary tactics and techniques based on real-world observations
- **OWASP:** An open community project providing information on common web application vulnerabilities and testing guides
- **NIST SP 800 Series:** US government standards for security and compliance, including guidelines for security testing and assessment
- **OSSTMM:** A manual outlining phases and general guidelines for security testing
- **PTES:** A detailed technical guide on tools and techniques for each phase of a penetration testing engagement

Student Notes Section